

Spark's Map and the Hidden Treasure

Hidden treasure story • 3-4 years old



Part One: The Mysterious Map

In a small, sunny forest, there lived a tiny dragon named Spark. Spark was not a big dragon, but he was very brave and very curious. One bright morning, Spark found something unusual. It was an old map with a big red « **X** » on it.

« **What is this?** » Spark wondered, looking closely at the map. « **It looks like a treasure map! How exciting!** »

Spark flapped his little wings with happiness. He knew this was the start of an adventure. « **I should find the treasure,** » he said, « **and maybe I can make a new friend along the way.** »

Spark looked around and saw his best friend, a wise old turtle named Timmy. « **Timmy, look what I found!** » Spark cheered, showing him the map.

Timmy nodded slowly, peering at the map through his tiny glasses. « **Ah, a treasure map,** » he said in his gentle voice. « **This could be fun, Spark. But we must be careful.** »

Spark agreed. He knew Timmy was always right about these things. « **Let's go together, Timmy! We can find the treasure and share it,** » said Spark happily.

So, off they went, following the crinkly map through the whispering trees and over the soft, green hills.

Part Two: The Journey Begins

The sun was warm, and the path was full of surprises. They stopped to smell colorful flowers and listen to the cheerful birds singing. Spark and Timmy laughed as they stumbled upon a patch of wild strawberries. They ate a few, and they were delicious!

As they walked, the map took them to a stream that sparkled in the sunlight. « **Oh, look, Timmy! We have to cross,** » said Spark, pointing to the stones scattered across the water.

« **Be careful, Spark,** » Timmy said with a soft smile. « **Step on the big, steady stones.** »

Spark nodded and hopped from stone to stone, feeling the cool water splash his little toes. Timmy followed slowly, enjoying the gentle breeze.

Across the stream, they found a small, hidden cave. It was dark but not scary. Spark took a deep breath. « **This must be it, Timmy. The treasure is inside!** »

Timmy chuckled. « **Let's see what we can find, my friend.** »

Part Three: The Treasure of Friendship

Inside the cave, it was cool and smelled like soft earth. Spark's heart beat fast with excitement. They followed the map's directions until they reached the big red « **X** » drawn on the ground.

« **Here it is!** » Spark exclaimed joyfully. The two friends began to dig with their tiny hands and claws. To their amazement, they found a wooden chest, old and covered in vines.

Slowly, they opened the chest, and inside they found a collection of shiny stones, bright as raindrops in the sun. There were sparkling blue sapphires, glittering green emeralds, and golden coins that shone like little suns.

Spark gasped. « **It's so beautiful, Timmy!** »

Timmy nodded, eyes twinkling. « **Yes, it is. But you know, Spark, the real treasure is the adventure we had together.** »

Spark thought for a moment and smiled. « **You're right, Timmy. The best treasure is our friendship.** »

Together, they decided to seal their friendship with the treasure. They took one gem each to remember the day and left the rest for others to find. They knew that sharing the treasure would make others happy, too.

As they left the cave, Spark felt warm inside, knowing he had a wonderful friend. « **Thank you, Timmy,** » he said, giving the turtle a gentle hug.

« **Thank you, Spark,** » replied Timmy, feeling very happy indeed.

And so, they headed home, their hearts full of joy, ready for their next adventure, and knowing that they had found the best treasure of all — each other.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the tiny dragon in the story?

- Spark
- Timmy
- A big lion
- A small bird

2) What did Spark find at the start?

- A map with a red X
- A shiny crown
- A magic wand
- A plate of cookies

3) Who is Spark's friend on the adventure?

- Timmy the turtle
- Polly the parrot
- Rex the rabbit
- Molly the mouse

4) What is the real treasure at the end?

- Their friendship
- A big cake
- A shiny car
- A toy robot

Correct answers:

1) Spark 2) A map with a red X 3) Timmy the turtle 4) Their friendship

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Mysterious: Something strange we do not understand, and it makes us wonder.

Crinkly: Making small crunching or crackling sounds when you touch it.

Whispering: Talking very quietly, like a soft sound in the trees.

Sparkled: Shined with many small bright points of light.

Scattered: Spread around in many different places, not in one spot.

Hidden: Kept out of sight so people cannot see it easily.

Cave: A dark, hollow place in a hill or rock that you can enter.

Directions: Short steps that tell you how to go from one place to another.

Vines: Thin plant stems that climb or hang down from trees or walls.

Amazement: A very big feeling of surprise and wonder.

Sapphires: Blue gemstones that are shiny and used as pretty decorations.

Emeralds: Green gemstones that are shiny and used as pretty decorations.

Glittering: Shining in small bright flashes, like tiny stars.

Seal: To close or fix something so it stays closed and safe.